

Policy

Remote work should not be mandatory across all jobs. Instead, organizations should adopt a default flexible-work framework that allows remote work where job duties can be performed effectively offsite, while preserving on-site requirements for roles that depend on in-person presence, specialized equipment, secure facilities, or direct service delivery.

Employers should:

- offer remote or hybrid options for eligible positions;
- document role-based criteria for on-site requirements;
- provide reasonable accommodations and remote-work support where applicable;
- review arrangements periodically to ensure productivity, fairness, and compliance.

Context

Remote work can lower costs, improve access to employment, reduce commuting burdens, and support continuity during disruptions. It can also improve work-life balance and reduce environmental impacts.

At the same time, many occupations cannot be performed remotely without reducing service quality, safety, or operational effectiveness. A universal mandate would limit employer discretion, create inequities across job types, and may weaken collaboration, mentorship, and onboarding in some settings.

Justification

This policy balances flexibility with practicality. It captures the benefits of remote work by making it broadly available where appropriate, rather than requiring it everywhere. That approach expands access for workers who benefit most from remote options while avoiding a one-size-fits-all rule that would be unworkable in many sectors.

The main trade-off is between consistency and operational fit. A blanket mandate offers simplicity, but it would impose costs on employers and employees in roles that require physical presence. A flexible standard preserves organizational autonomy while still encouraging remote work in eligible positions.

Conditions are essential. Remote work should be based on job function, not preference alone, and employers should periodically reassess eligibility as technology, safety requirements, and business needs change. Where remote work is offered, organizations should address home-office burdens through clear expectations, support policies, and accommodation processes.

Expected outcomes include wider labor-force participation, lower commuting pressure, better continuity during disruptions, and improved employee retention in suitable roles, while maintaining effectiveness, fairness, and legal compliance in jobs that must remain on site.